

安心して乳房撮影を受けていただくために



# Mammogram Q&A

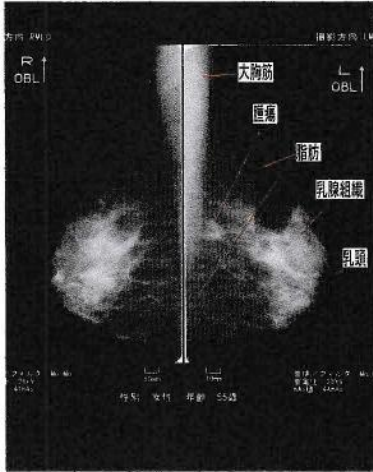
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## Q. What should I be careful of when getting a mammogram?

- **Pacemakers**: Patients with cardiac pacemakers generally cannot undergo mammography.
- **Breast Implants**: The imaging method is different for those who have had breast augmentation surgery, so you must inform the staff.
- **Deodorants & Powders**: The imaging range includes the breast and the underarm area. These products may show up on the scan, so please wipe them off thoroughly. (Wet wipes are available in the exam room; please feel free to ask).
- **Medical History**: Please inform the technologist of any concerning symptoms, previous surgeries, or scars to help with a better diagnosis.

Due to hormones, breasts may become firm or painful between ovulation and the start of menstruation. It is recommended to schedule your exam about one week after your period starts, when breast tension and pain are minimal.

## Q. What is mammography?



Mammography is a specialized X-ray scan of the breast. Because breasts are made of soft tissue, a dedicated machine is used. This specialized device is designed to cut out radiation that is harmful to the human body during imaging.

It can find various breast diseases, including very early-stage breast cancer (calcifications) that cannot be felt as a lump. Typically, two views are taken of each breast to ensure the entire three-dimensional breast is captured on the film without omission. The imaging takes about 20 minutes. Afterward, there may be a short wait while the tech confirms the images.

## Q. Are there any risks from radiation exposure?

While mammography involves X-rays, the radiation is limited only to the breast area. It does not affect bone marrow and carries no risk of causing leukemia.

The benefit of detecting early-stage breast cancer through imaging far outweighs the risks of radiation exposure.

Amount of natural  
radiation you receive  
during a round-trip  
flight between Tokyo  
and New York.



Amount of radiation  
received in one exam



## Q.How is the imaging performed?

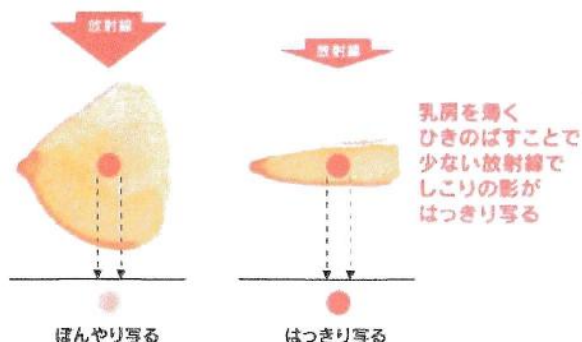
The breast is sandwiched and compressed between plates. This is essential for taking the high-quality photos needed for diagnosis.

Breasts are three-dimensional and thick; if imaged as-is, overlapping mammary glands, fat, and blood vessels may hide actual tumors.

Compression also reduces the total amount of radiation exposure.

By thinning and stretching the breast, the shadow of a lump is imaged more clearly compared to a blurred image.

While some patients may feel strong pain, we ask for your cooperation during the test. If the pain is unbearable, do not hesitate to tell the tech.



Our facility includes radiologists and surgeons certified in mammogram interpretation, and technologists certified in mammography techniques. We use equipment that meets appropriate dosage and quality standards and hold "Mammography Screening Facility Image Certification." All imaging is performed by female radiologic technologists.

平成20年1月15日 改訂

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